RMIT University Vietnam
BUSM4573 Business Communications & Professional Practice
Semester B/2026

PEOPLE
PLACES
POSSIBILITIES



VOCO™
BY IHG

Rhythm of the Bay

A MORE CONSIDERATE STAY

ASSIGNMENT 3

Business Improvement (Brand Awareness) Report & Professional Communication Reflection

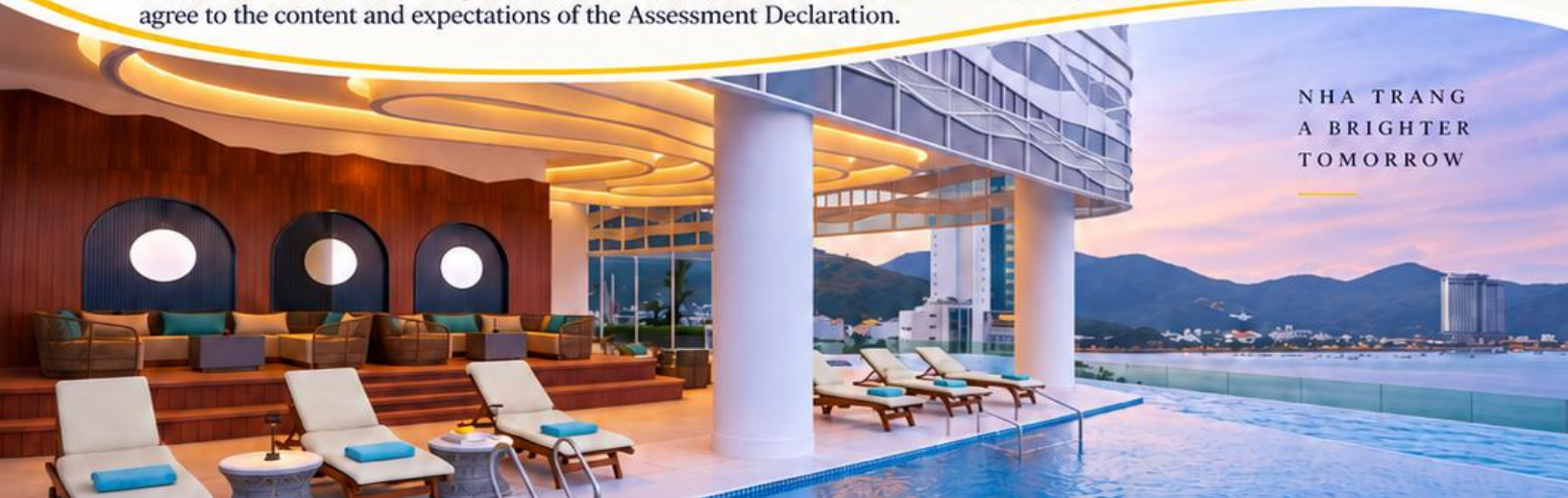
Industry Partner (case study): voco Scenia Bay Nha Trang

Good Stays Brighter Days

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We declare that in submitting all work for this assessment we have read, understood, and agree to the content and expectations of the Assessment Declaration.



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Executive Summary

voco Scenia Bay Nha Trang enters a rapidly growing yet highly competitive coastal tourism market, where similar premium hotel offerings make it difficult for a new property to achieve strong brand awareness. Research finds that beachfront facilities and premium hospitality alone are insufficient to differentiate voco, while the brand has not yet established a strong association with the distinctive Nha Trang experience. As travelers increasingly discover and evaluate destinations through digital and AI-related touchpoints, this creates an opportunity to strengthen voco's visibility and memorability through distinctive digital experiences.

The report therefore recommends two AI differentiation strategies: personalized “If Nha Trang Had a Voice” destination storytelling and an interactive 360-degree virtual tour supported by multilingual AI narration. Respectively, these are supported by strategic content updates and linked assets to mitigate risks while remaining technically, legally, and operationally viable with minimal expenditure. Ultimately, the proposed strategies are expected to reinforce voco Scenia Bay Nha Trang’s brand awareness and establish a more distinctive and recognizable brand presence in the Nha Trang market.

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1. Introduction

Vietnam's tourism sector is entering a digitally mediated growth phase, with the country targeting 25M international visitors and 150M domestic travellers in 2026. Against this backdrop, voco Scenia Bay Nha Trang combines coastal tranquillity with city access (IHG 2026a). In a competitive coastal market, however, visibility alone is insufficient; a new entrant must build a distinctive brand meaning that converts awareness into consideration. This challenge is intensified by the growing role of AI in travel planning, which is reshaping hotel discovery and consideration. Accordingly, this report develops two feasible AI-enabled strategies to strengthen differentiation, engagement, and brand consideration.

2. Brand Overview

2.1 Company & Brand Overview

voco Scenia Bay is a premium hotel in the north of Nha Trang by IHG, opened on 31 March 2026 as a 250-room premium urban resort. voco brings a premium lifestyle brand defined by indulgent personalized comfort. In Nha Trang, the hotel brings this brand philosophy to the coastal destination, positioning itself as a contemporary benchmark for premium hospitality.

2.2 Product and Service Focus

voco Scenia Bay Nha Trang offers an upper-upscale beachfront stay with private, premium facilities. Its brand proposition centers on a hotel that brings a relaxed coastal sophistication, distinct from a formal resort experience, with sweeping ocean-view rooms, a rare sea-facing ballroom for meetings and celebrations, an infinity pool perched above the bay, and a curated dining journey.

3. Marketing Environment

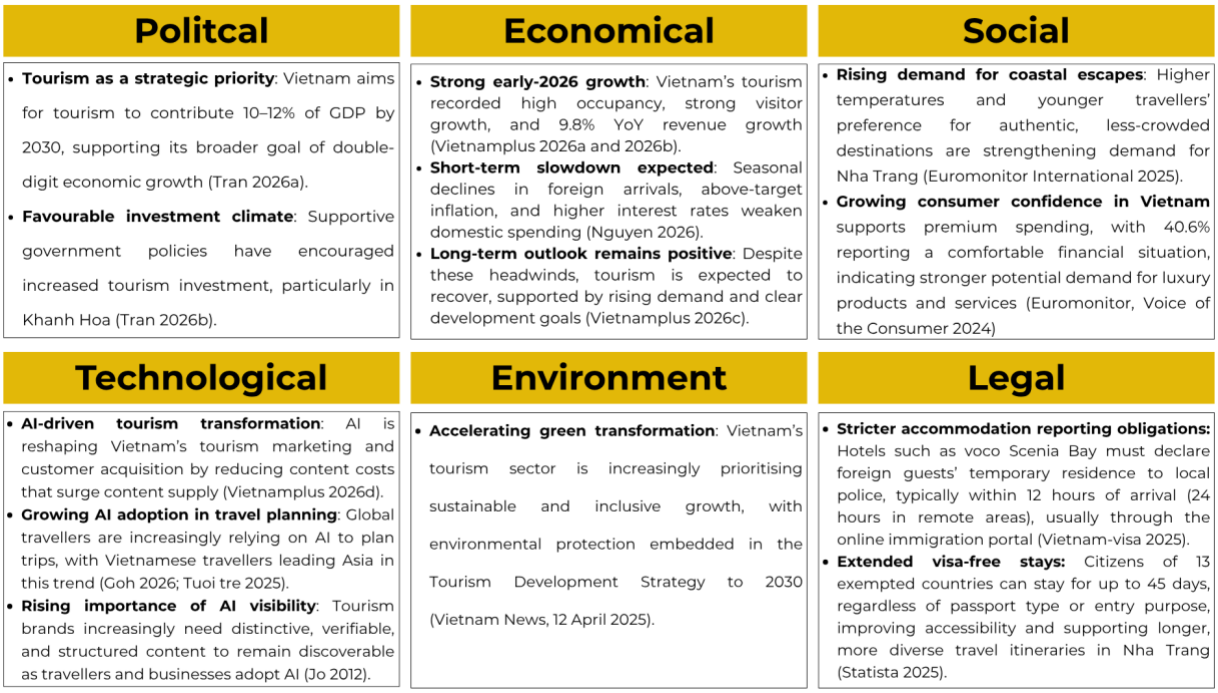


Figure 1. *PESTLE analysis of Vietnam's tourism industry*

Taken together, these conditions create favourable tailwinds but a hostile attention environment. Supporting policy and rising consumer confidence are expanding Nha Trang's traveller pool, while content costs fall; supply surges, and travellers increasingly delegate discovery to AI. Thus, brand awareness now requires AI-surfaceable content alongside distinctive and verifiable assets.

4. Customer Strategy

4.1 Segmentation

The market is segmented using a hybrid approach combining origin, travel purpose, desired experience, and digital discovery behaviour (Kotler and Keller 2016).

Segment	Geographic & behavioural	Psychographic	Behavioural & Digital	Relevance
South Korean leisure	South Korea; couples/families, independent travellers	Premium beach escapes, local experiences	Digitally planning; and social proof	Highest
Vietnamese domestic leisure	Major urban centres (Hanoi, HCMC); couples/families	Relaxation, value, culture/cuisine	High mobile and AI-planning receptiveness	High
Other international leisure	Russia, Kazakhstan, China and other Asian markets	Beach/resort experiences, value	Destination-led discovery	Growth market
MICE/business	Corporate groups	Reliability, efficiency, and prestige	Structured B2B decision-making	Secondary

Figure 2. *voco's Market Segmentation Table*

4.2 Targeting

voco Scenia Bay should adopt a dual-target strategy: South Korean leisure travellers as the primary target and Vietnamese domestic leisure travellers as the secondary target.

South Korea represents Khanh Hoa's dominant international source market, contributing more than 2.4 million visitors in 2024, approximately 50% of international arrivals. Nha Trang was also Koreans' most searched international summer destination in 2025 (Khanh Hoa News 2025b). With approximately 98% internet penetration, this market is also highly digitally addressable, as travellers actively use social platforms for travel information (International Trade Administration 2026).

Vietnamese travellers complement this scale with strong experiential and AI fit. Agoda's 2026 Travel Outlook identifies relaxation, cultural exploration, and culinary experiences as their three leading travel motivations; 50% intend to travel more domestically, up from 26% previously (Agoda 2026b). Their relevance is strengthened further by AI adoption: 81% are likely to use AI for trip planning, compared with a 63% Asian average (Agoda 2026a).

This dual-target strategy prioritises South Korea for immediate scale, while Vietnam strengthens domestic demand resilience and AI-mediated discovery.

4.3 Differentiation Strategy

Nha Trang's premium hotels communicate overlapping benefits, particularly beachfront settings, relaxation and international service. Differentiation therefore requires voco Scenia Bay to identify a combination of benefits that competitors do not emphasize in the same way.

InterContinental Nha Trang and Sheraton similarly emphasize central accessibility and international hospitality, while Fusion Resort Cam Ranh builds a substantially stronger wellness-led proposition and resort immersion (IHG 2026b; Marriott International 2026; Fusion Hotel Group 2026).



Figure 3. *voco's Differentiation Strategy*

voco Scenia Bay differentiates through seaside tranquillity, city accessibility and local character. Its "rare balance of seaside serenity and city ease" complement voco's "Reliably Different" proposition of individual character backed by global-brand reassurance (IHG 2026a; IHG Hotels & Resorts 2026).

Accordingly, rather than out-luxury InterContinental or out-wellness Fusion, voco should own:

> A locally expressive coastal retreat with city access.

4.4 Positioning Map



Figure 4. *voco's Positioning Map*

Figure 1 visualizes voco's position between urban-accessible international hotels and more secluded, resort-led competitors, reinforcing its positioning as an urban resort that combines city connection with seaside calm (IHG 2026a; IHG 2026b; Marriott International 2026; Fusion Hotel Group 2026). Placements reflect publicly communicated brand propositions rather than primary consumer-perception research.

4.5 Value Proposition

voco Scenia Bay resolves two consumer tensions: tranquility without isolation and local character without uncertainty, combining coastal calm and city access with the reassurance of IHG standards (IHG 2026a).

Value Proposition: *"A calmer, more locally expressive way to experience Nha Trang, combining the feeling of a coastal retreat with the convenience and reassurance of an international premium hotel."*

This creates a distinctive proposition that can be consistently communicated across digital discovery, social content, and AI-enabled travel touchpoints.

4.6 Positioning Statement

For digitally connected South Korean leisure travellers seeking a premium coastal escape, voco Scenia Bay is an urban coastal resort combining seaside tranquillity, locally expressive experiences and city access, backed by its northern-bay location, distinctive voco identity, and IHG's global premium standards.

5. SWOT & Strategic Analysis

5.1 SWOT Analysis

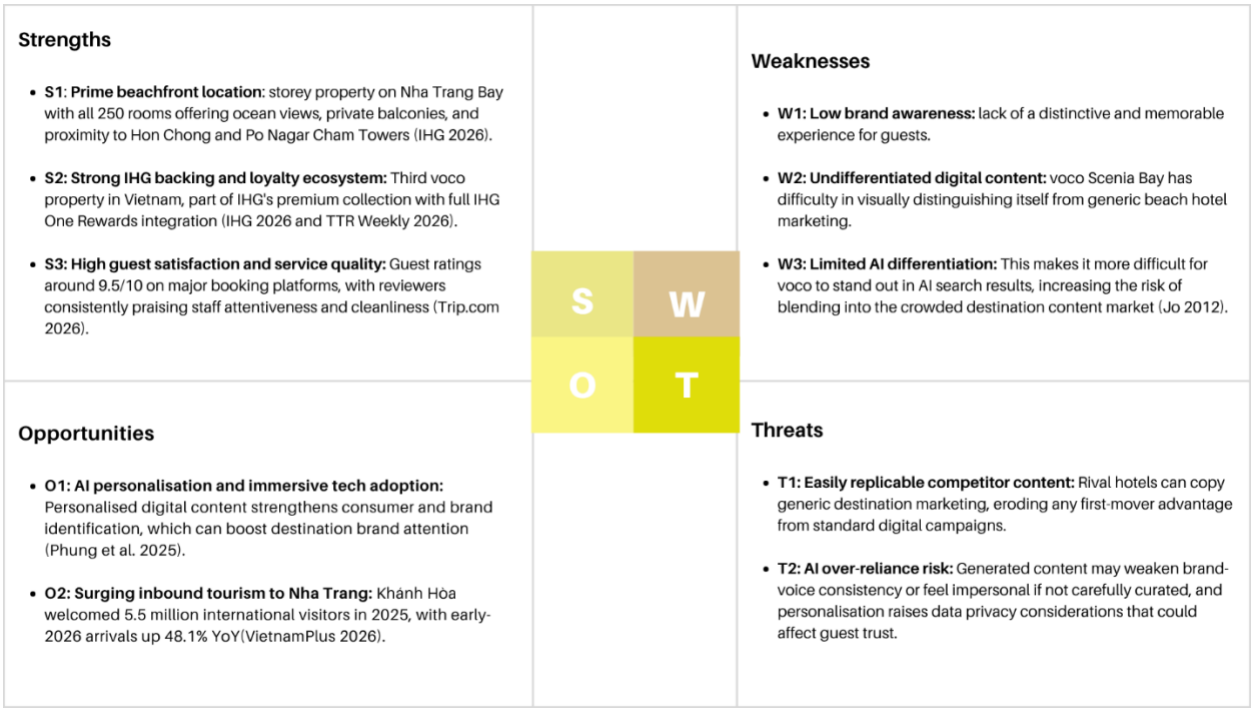


Figure 5. *voco's SWOT Analysis*

The SWOT table shows internal and external factors aligned with voco's current market position. voco Scenia Bay benefits from strong service quality and a prime location, but faces limited brand differentiation despite favourable tourism growth. This highlights a gap between rising visitor demand and voco's low brand recognition, positioning differentiation as the hotel's most pressing strategic priority. As a result, strengthening brand identity and digital differentiation emerges as a more urgent focus than addressing external threats.

5.2 Business Problem (5Whys-Appendix A)

voco Scenia Bay Nha Trang faces a brand-awareness and differentiation challenge in the competitive upscale coastal hotel market. As a relatively new brand, voco has had limit time to build familiarity than established competitors. Its youthful, flexible, and informal positioning therefore requires stronger efforts to increase recognition among domestic and international travellers (The Brand Promise 2026).

Competition further increases this challenge. In 2026, Khánh Hòa recorded approximately 1,441 accommodation establishments and over 70,500 rooms, creating an increasingly crowded upscale hospitality market (Thanh 2026). As many hotels rely on similar visuals of rooms, pools, and ocean views, differentiation and brand recall become more difficult.

Furthermore, voco Scenia Bay has yet to create a strong association between the voco brand and the unique Nha Trang experience. Its social media communication remains relatively general across customer segments, limiting emotional engagement and shareable experiences. Consequently, travellers may recognise Nha Trang as a destination without strongly associating it with voco Scenia Bay, reducing top-of-mind awareness (Duong et al. 2025). Therefore, this report proposes AI-personalised destination storytelling and an AI-enabled 360º virtual tour to strengthen emotional connection, social sharing, and experiential differentiation.

5.3 TOWS Strategy

This report selects the WO strategies as the most appropriate for voco Scenia Bay's current position. The WO strategy applies AI personalisation and immersive technology (O1) to address low brand awareness and undifferentiated digital content (W1, W2) by delivering tailored destination stories based on individual traveller preferences and strengthening prospective guests' engagement with voco before arrival. As competing hotel brands adopt similar technologies, voco Scenia Bay is better positioned early to establish itself in guests' minds as a technologically forward-thinking and personalised hotel brand.

6. Recommendations

6.1 Recommendation 1

Concept & Key Activities: An AI-powered personalised destination storytelling experience where guests select a travel mood (romance, relaxation, food, adventure, or culture) and answer a few short questions about their trip. The system then generates a "Your Nha Trang" digital postcard using a curated library of local imagery, ambient sounds, and sensory storytelling, with a subtle connection to voco experience. Users can access and share their personalised postcards through the hotel website, with a pre-approved content library ensuring consistent destination storytelling and brand alignment (Appendix B).

Problem addressed: This recommendation addresses undifferentiated digital content, weak emotional connection, and limited organic sharing. In a market where coastal imagery is easy to imitate, the challenge is to make Nha Trang memories attached to voco Scenia Bay rather than a generic beach hotel.

Strategy: Conventional hotel marketing often focuses on facilities and standard service features, which are easily compared and forgotten (Murniati and Bawono 2020). In contrast, personalised destination storytelling creates emotionally relevant experiences that strengthen consumer–brand identification and positive attitudes toward the hotel (Phung et al. 2025). Its personalised and shareable content can improve memorability, encourage organic visibility, and enhance brand awareness through digital engagement (Silalahi and Guna 2024). Therefore, repeated exposure to personalized Nha Trang - voco Scenia Bay stories can strengthen the currently weak destination-hotel association (Shizhen et al.2025).

Customer touchpoints:

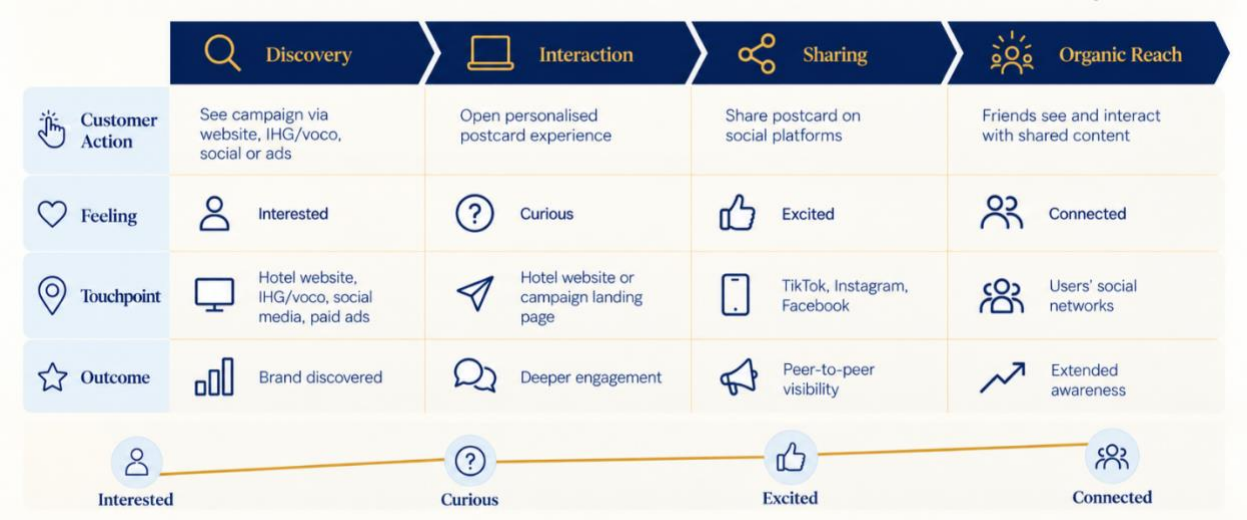


Figure 6. *Customer Touchpoint in Recommendation 1*

AI application: AI is used in two straightforward ways: (i) to interpret the traveller's inputs and select the most relevant combination from a brand-approved library (constrained AI), protecting brand-voice consistency; and (ii) to tailor the accompanying story to the traveller. Limited personal data is required beyond the guests stated preferences, keeping privacy exposure low.

6.2 Recommendation 2

Concept & Key Activities: An interactive 360-degree spatial virtual tour of voco that allows prospective guests to explore the hotel's full property experience before arrival. Using 360-degree photography or spatial video combined with AI-generated multilingual narration, the tour provides personalised explanations of each area's atmosphere, distinctive features, and role within the voco brand experience (Appendix C).

Problem addressed: This recommendation addresses the limits of static hotel content by allowing potential guests to explore voco Scenia Bay more actively before arrival. The virtual tour can strengthen differentiation, improve recall of distinctive spaces, reduce language barriers through multilingual narration, and present the hotel's location advantage. Overall, it improves pre-arrival understanding, brand engagement, and memorability.

Strategy: A 360-degree virtual tour enhances the sense of authenticity and place identity can reduce uncertainty, improve perceived differentiation, and strengthen travellers' connection with the brand, particularly among those unfamiliar with voco (Chekembayeva and Garaus 2024). Additionally, multilingual AI-generated narration improves accessibility for international visitors by delivering relevant information in their preferred language and increasing engagement during the decision-making process (Maratbay 2025).

Customer touchpoints:



Figure 7. *Customer Touchpoint in Recommendation 2*

AI application: The experience uses a web-based 360-degree VR tour, allowing users to explore the hotel through a smartphone, tablet, or computer without requiring a VR headset (Peruzzini et al. 2023). AI is used to provide multilingual narration in key languages such as Vietnamese, English, Korean, Chinese, and Russian (Sravanthi and Deepthi 2025). Approved hotel scripts are translated and converted into natural-sounding narration, helping maintain consistent brand messaging across languages.



Figure 8. *Objective achieved from two recommendations*

The two recommendations are designed to complement rather than replace each other. “If Nha Trang Had a Voice” builds emotional and social connections by linking voco Scenia Bay with a memorable destination story, while the 360-degree virtual tour enhances understanding of the hotel’s distinctive spaces and provides tangible information that supports evaluation and differentiation. Together, they address different barriers confirmed in the 5 Whys and strengthen pre-arrival brand memory through both emotional engagement and experiential understanding.

6.3 Implementation & Stakeholders Responsibilities

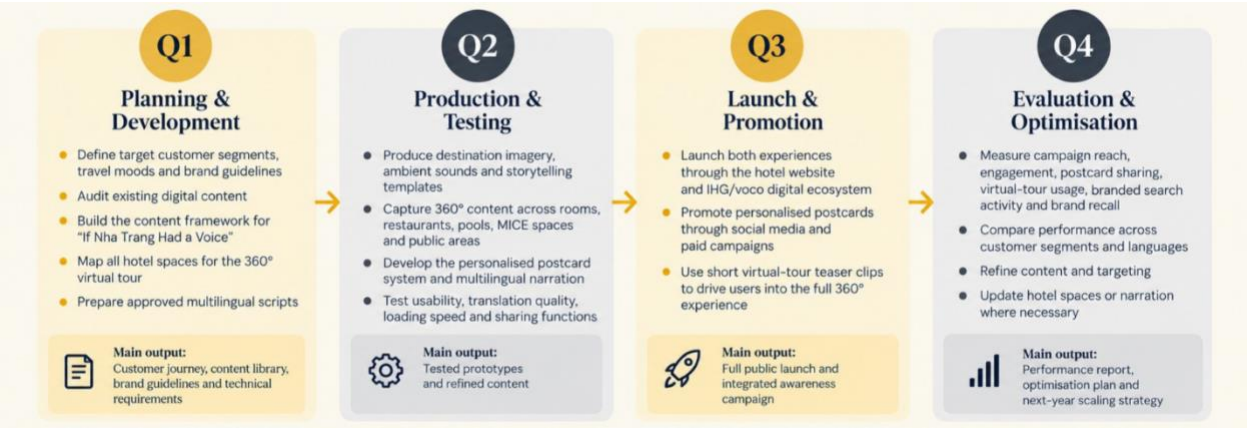


Figure 9. Customer Journey

The two recommendations will be implemented throughout the four quarters, progressing from development and testing to launch and optimisation to maximise their impact on brand recall and customer engagement.

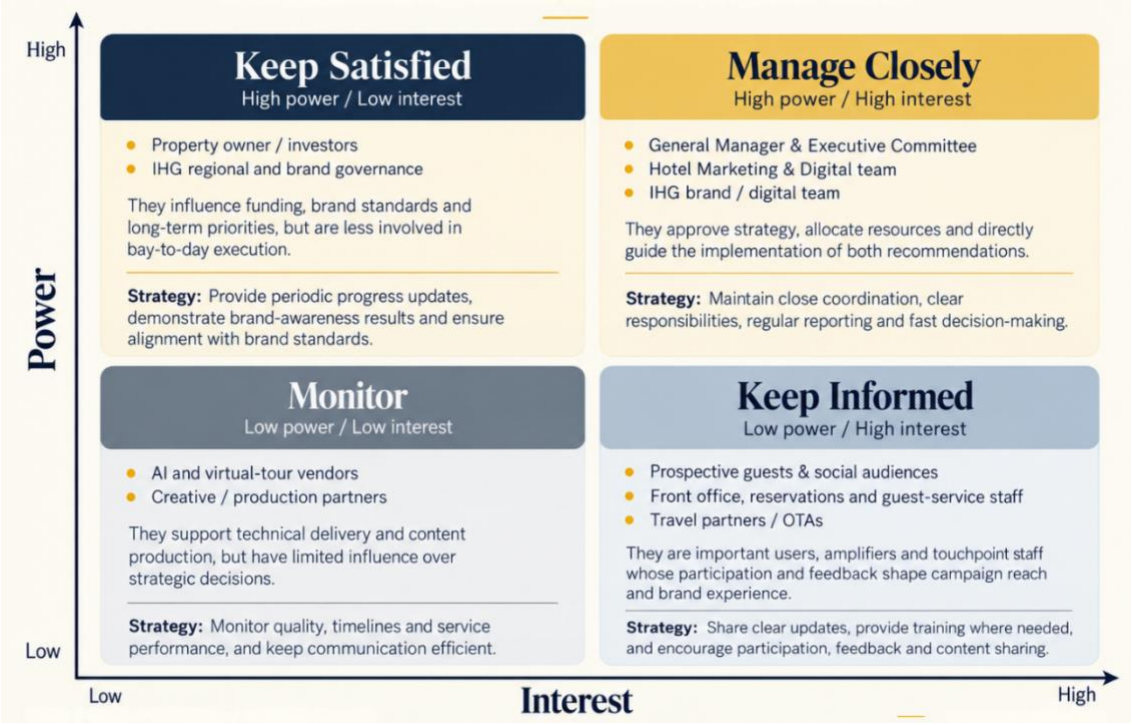


Figure 10. Stakeholder on Power/Interest Grid

The Power/Interest Grid is applied to classify key stakeholders according to their level of influence and interest in the two proposed innovations, helping voco determine the appropriate engagement strategy for each group (Eden and Ackermann 2021).

6.4 Expected Outcomes & KPIs



Figure 11. *SMART objectives and KPIs*

7. Feasibility and Limitations

7.1 Feasibility

To assess the feasibility of the recommendations, we evaluate them using the TELOS framework (Putri et al. 2025).

Technical

The technical requirements for both initiatives can already be addressed using publicly available generative AI technologies, making them relatively easy for voco to implement without extensive R&D. Specifically, with constrained AI applied to mitigate hallucinations of open-ended generation, voco can implement both initiatives through project-based API development. This can be achieved by contracting a technical team to integrate existing off-the-shelf technologies to deliver the desired outputs to customers (Blümel et al. 2024; Figures 12 and 13).

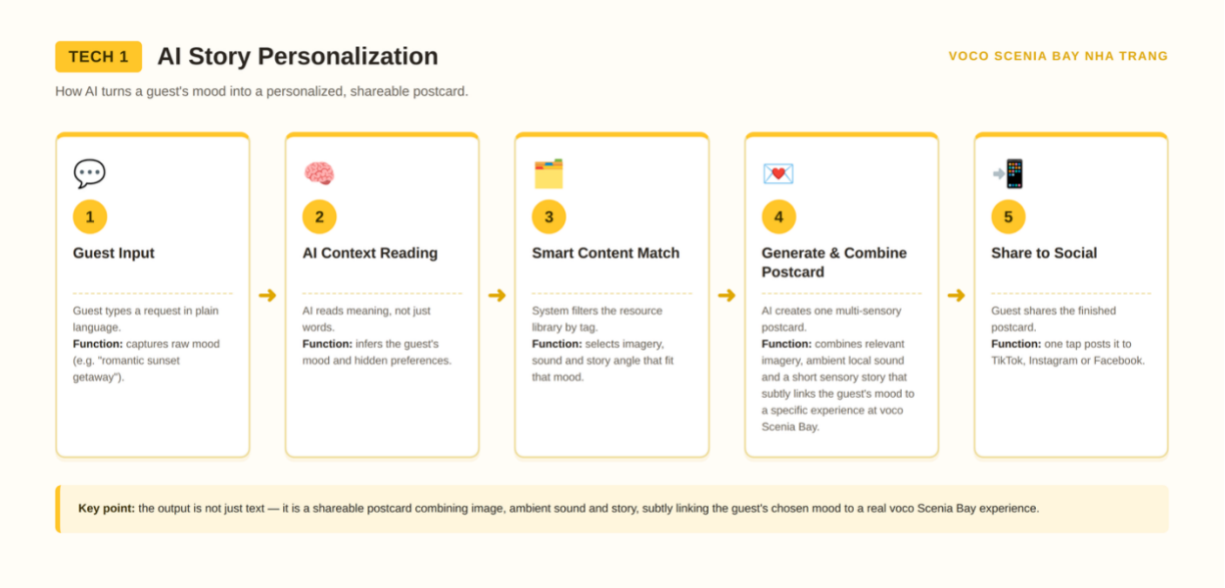


Figure 12. *Technical AI Story Personalization*

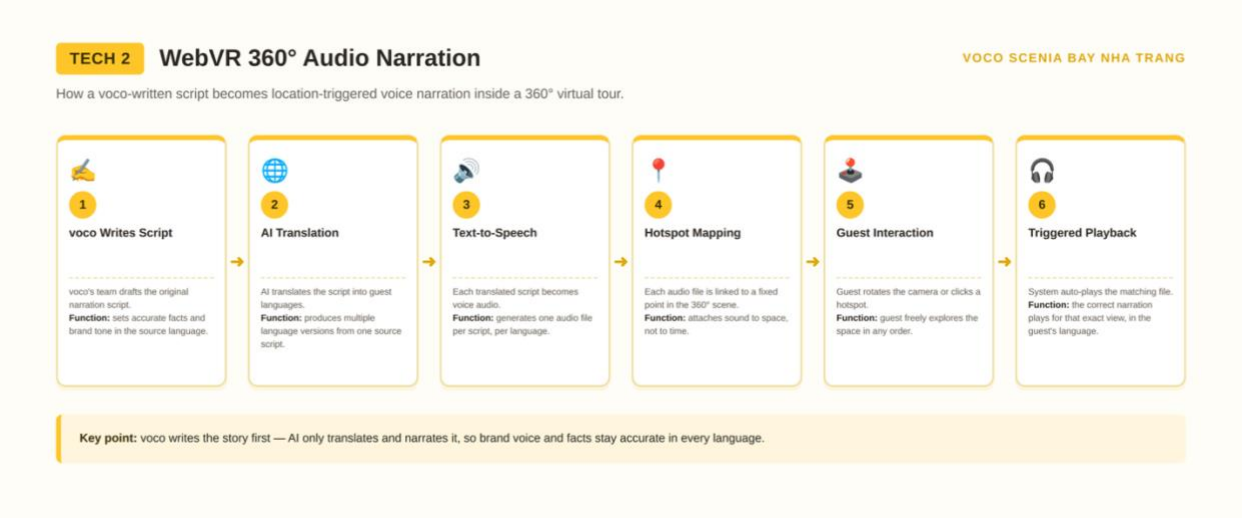


Figure 13. *Technical Web 360-degree Audio Narration*

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Economical

Although both initiatives can share one delivery team, Recommendation 2 concentrates spending in a one-off capture phase, with costs recurring only when the property changes. In contrast, Recommendation 1 carries continuous maintenance and content-refresh costs. Nevertheless, both remain affordable for voco, representing only a small fraction of total revenue and remaining below the 7-12% marketing investment threshold (Figure 14; Victor 2026).

FINANCIAL ESTIMATION

Recommendation 1				
Item		**Price**	**Source**	
API Project-Based Developer	VND	50,000,000	Zderic 2026	
Maintainance and Upgrading (monthly)	VND	2,000,000		
Recommendation 2				
Item		**Price**	**Source**	
360 Tour Price	VND	30,000,000	Tour 360 n.d.	
AI Script Translate and Intergration	VND	15,000,000		
Total Cost				
Total Cost (Rec 1 + 2)	**VND**	**95,000,000**		
Cost Structure Analysis Monthly				
Occupancy Rate		**Monthly Revenue**	**OpEx as % of revenue**	**Investment as % of revenue**
100%	VND	28,209,000,000	0.01%	0.34%
70%	VND	19,746,300,000	0.01%	0.48%
50%	VND	14,104,500,000	0.01%	0.67%
30%	VND	8,462,700,000	0.02%	1.12%

Figure 14. *Financial Estimation of two recommendations (Zderic 2026; Tour360 n.d.)*

Legal

Both recommendations remain feasible, provided that compliance requirements are met. Vietnam's Personal Data Protection Law (91/2025/QH15) requires informed consent, data processing transparency, and rights of access and erasure. Thus, for Recommendation 1, information must be provided and consent obtained before generating the postcard (Bo Cong An 2026). Recommendation 2 carries lower exposure, but the tour is itself advertising and must comply with the amended Law on Advertising (75/2025/QH15), requiring accurate representation of the property (Vanban.chinh phu 2025).

Operational

Regarding operational feasibility, the project will be outsourced and directly reach customers without interrupting voco's existing systems, allowing for fast and seamless adaptation. However, voco will remain responsible for quality assurance, including curating the digital postcard content library, verifying translations, and approving the final digital tour outputs.

Scheduling

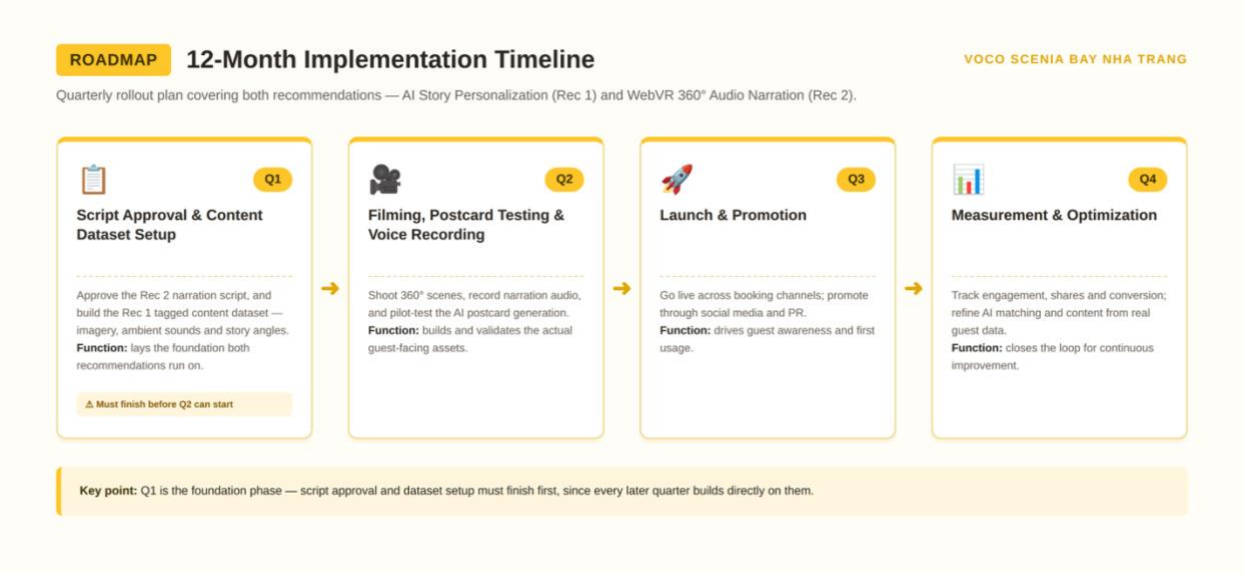


Figure 15. *12-month Implementation Timeline*

The 12-month timeline is sufficient to achieve the target gains. However, Q1 and Q2 should be front-loaded for sequential, less flexible product development, ideally during the low season when customer traffic is lower, and filming is easier. Later phases have more slack, as it can be compressed if delays occur. Therefore, protecting the first two milestones is more important than shortening the overall timeline.

7.2 Limitations

7.2.1 Recommendation 1

For Recommendation 1, using Constrained AI with a pre-approved database limits the range of available outputs. As adoption grows, more customers may receive similar postcards. If customers receive nearly identical postcards and share them online, the promise of personalisation weakens and sharing motivation may decline just as the programme reaches peak engagement. Therefore, voco should refresh the content library periodically and introduce annual or seasonal themes. It can also add unique customer inputs (name or personal quote) to each postcard. This combination increases content variety and personalisation, reducing saturation while retaining the benefits of Constrained AI.

7.2.2 Recommendation 2

A key limitation of Recommendation 2 is imitation risk, as 360-degree tours are widely available and inexpensive to reproduce, allowing competitors to replicate the service, shifting it from a Point of Difference to a Point of Parity (Jo 2012). Accordingly, investment should target the content layer, using the tour as evidence for voco's value position rather than as a feature. Critically, its captured assets can also supply Recommendation 1's library, so competitors must reproduce the whole system rather than a single artefact.

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8. Conclusion

In conclusion, voco Scenia Bay Nha Trang competes in a growing but crowded upscale coastal market where beachfront facilities and premium service alone no longer differentiate. Its core challenge is low brand awareness alongside a weak association between the voco brand and the Nha Trang experience. Two complementary AI-enabled strategies, personalised "If Nha Trang Had a Voice" destination storytelling and an interactive 360-degree virtual tour with multilingual narration, together aim to strengthen emotional connection, social sharing and pre-arrival understanding. The TELOS assessment confirms that both initiatives are feasible at modest cost. Altogether, if managed against the stated KPIs, they should establish a more distinctive and memorable brand presence.

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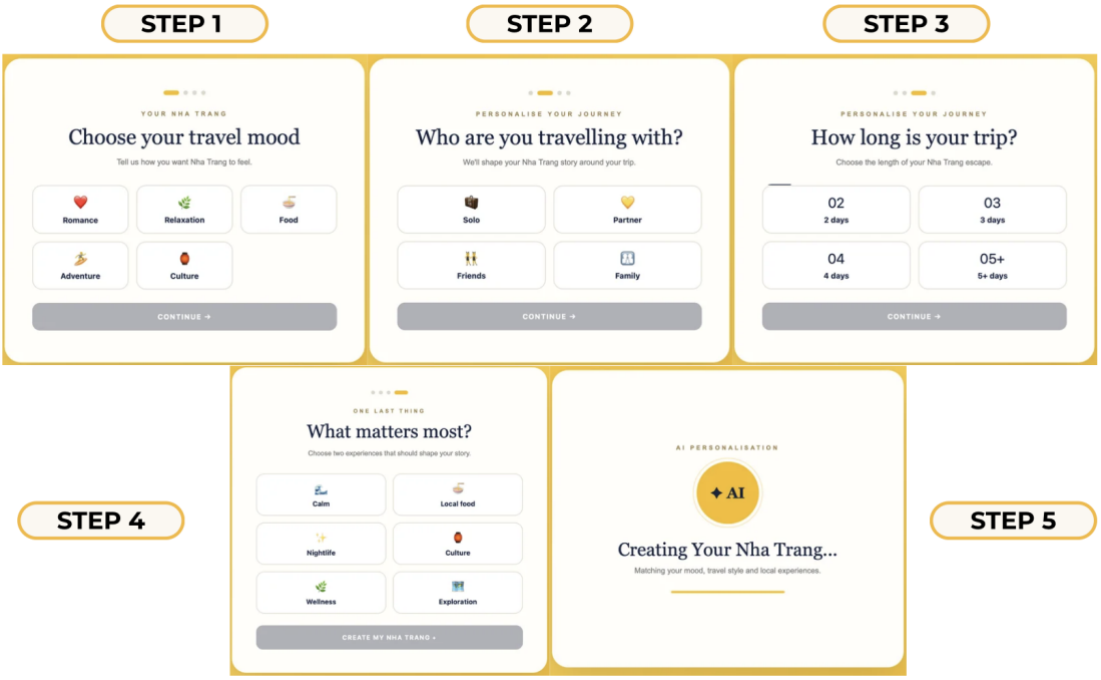
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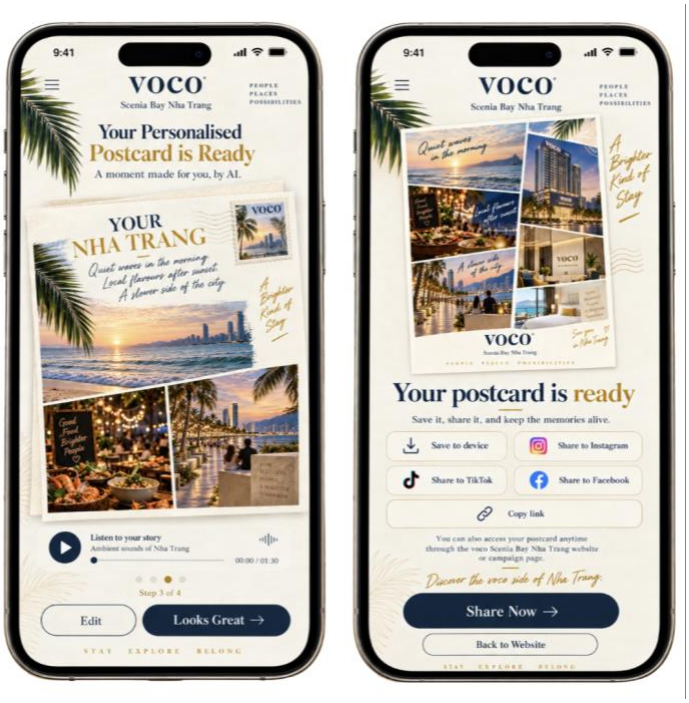
Appendix A

Question	Analysis
Problem	**What is the main problem?** voco Scenia Bay Nha Trang has low brand awareness among both domestic and international travellers considering hotels in Nha Trang.
1 Why 1	**Why does this problem occur?** The hotel only opened in March 2026, so it has had limited time to build online visibility, customer reviews and organic social-media exposure compared with established competitors.
2 Why 2	**What is the reason for this situation?** Current digital communication relies mainly on hotel information and conventional photography, with limited distinctive or shareable content that can attract attention and increase organic reach.
3 Why 3	**What deeper marketing or customer-experience issue causes it?** Much of the content focuses on facilities and location, which are also commonly promoted by other upscale beachfront hotels. This makes it harder for potential guests to remember voco Scenia Bay or develop an emotional connection with the brand before arrival.
4 Why 4	**What organisational, digital or competitive factor contributes to it?** voco Scenia Bay competes with both established international hotel brands and other IHG properties in Nha Trang, but its digital communication does not yet communicate a sufficiently distinctive identity and pre-arrival experience.
5 Why 5	**What is the underlying root cause the recommendations should address?** The key root cause is a weak association between Nha Trang and the voco Scenia Bay brand. The hotel's current digital presence does not yet create a distinctive and memorable experience that encourages potential guests to recognise, remember and share the brand.

Appendix B

Recommendation 1 MOCKUP



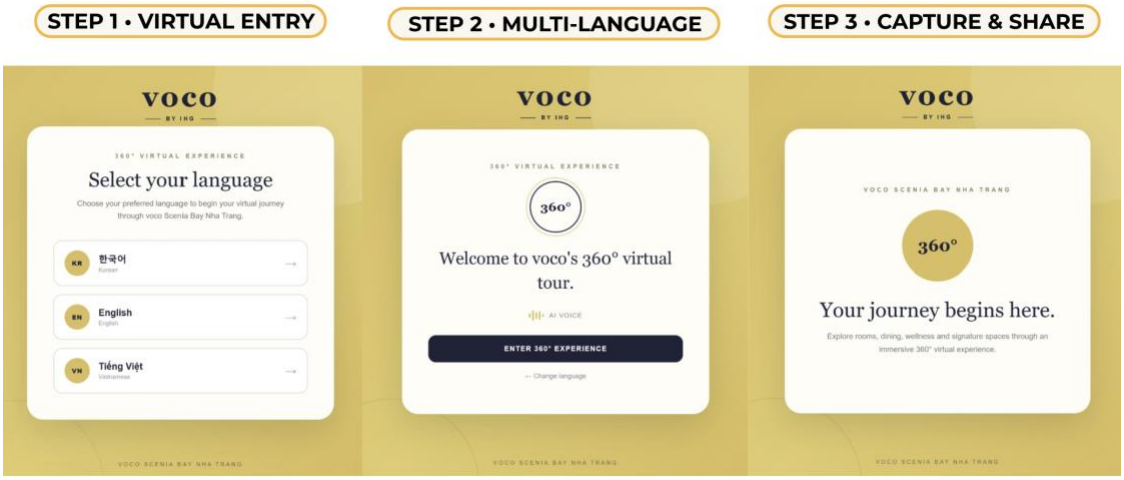


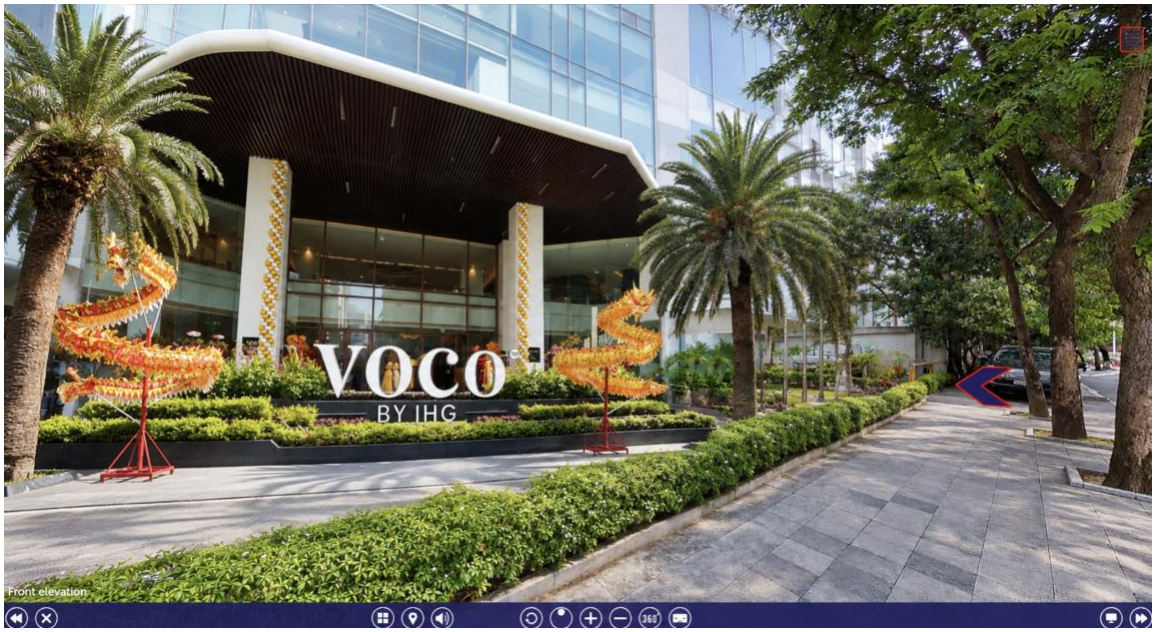
Live Prototype

GITHUB PAGES LINK: https://ngyenscar9-stack.github.io/voco-nhatrangvoice/

Appendix C

Recommendation 2 MOCKUP





Live Prototype

GITHUB PAGES LINK: https://ngyenscar9-stack.github.io/voco-Scenia-Bay-Nha-Trang-360-degree-virtual-tour/